Multimedia Appendix 2. STROBE checklist. Early Renewal of Accountable Care Organization Agreements to Reset Benchmarks in the Medicare Shared Savings Program: Preregistered Retrospective Cohort Study

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Items of the STROBE statement for cohort studies,[1] with the place each is reported in the manuscript or in Multimedia Appendix 1 (eTables and eMethods).

STROBE checklist

Item	No.	Recommendation (abbreviated)	Where reported
Title and abstract	1	Indicate the design; give an informative, balanced summary	Title and Abstract (preregistered retrospective cohort study)
Background/rationale	2	Scientific background and rationale	Introduction, paragraphs 1-3
Objectives	3	Specific objectives and prespecified hypotheses	Introduction, paragraph 4; Methods, Hypotheses
Study design	4	Key elements of the design	Methods, Study Design and Preregistration
Setting	5	Setting, locations, dates of recruitment, exposure, follow-up, data collection	Methods, Data Sources; Population and Groups
Participants	6	Eligibility criteria, sources and methods of selection; follow-up	Methods, Population and Groups; Figure 1
Variables	7	Define outcomes, exposures, predictors, confounders, effect modifiers	Methods, Variables; Hypotheses

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Item	No.	Recommendation (abbreviated)	Where reported
Data Sources/measurement	8	Sources and methods of measurement; comparability	Methods, Data Sources; Variables (Validation Before Use); eTable 1; eTable 12 (post hoc, change scale)
Bias	9	Efforts to address potential sources of bias	Methods, Study Design and Preregistration (outcome lock), Statistical Analysis (equivalence condition); Discussion, Limitations
Study size	10	How the study size was arrived at	Methods, Population and Groups (all eligible ACOs); Power; eTable 2
Quantitative variables	11	How quantitative variables were handled; groupings	Methods, Variables; Statistical Analysis (scaling by 2 SD)
Statistical methods	12a	All statistical methods, including for confounding	Methods, Statistical Analysis
	12b	Methods for subgroups and interactions	None registered; single-cohort restrictions in eTables 3-4
	12c	How missing data were addressed	Methods, Variables (Suppressed Values); Results, Validation and Sample
	12d	How loss to follow-up was addressed	Methods, Statistical Analysis (not yet renewed; balanced panel); eTable 8
	12e	Sensitivity analyses	Methods, Covariate-Adjusted Estimates, Conventional Methods, and Robustness; eTables 3-6
Participants	13a	Numbers at each stage	Figure 1; Results, Validation and Sample
	13b	Reasons for nonparticipation at each stage	Figure 1; Results, Validation and Sample
	13c	Flow diagram	Figure 1
Descriptive data	14a	Characteristics of participants; exposures and confounders	Table 1 (group, cohort, track, case mix, savings rate, constructed variables); the H3 adjustment factors (size, revenue category, assignment method, agreement number) are not in the results files and are not tabulated
	14b	Number with missing data for each variable	Table 1; Figure 1
	14c	Follow-up time	eTable 8 (mean included post-period years by group)
Outcome data	15	Numbers of outcome events or summary measures over time	Early renewal: 29 of 306 compared ACOs (Table 1), 24 of 206 in H3 (Table 3); spending over time: eTable 11

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Item	No.	Recommendation (abbreviated)	Where reported
Main results	16a	Unadjusted and adjusted estimates with precision	Tables 2-4; Figures 2-4; eTables 3, 6
	16b	Category boundaries for continuous variables	Not applicable (continuous variables not categorized)
	16c	Translation of relative risk into absolute risk	Results (odds multiplier; dollar translation); eTable 5 (observed and predicted shares by decile)
Other analyses	17	Subgroups, interactions and sensitivity analyses	Results, Robustness and Conventional Methods; eTables 3-11
Key results	18	Summarize key results with reference to objectives	Discussion, Principal Findings
Limitations	19	Sources of potential bias or imprecision; direction and magnitude	Discussion, Limitations
Interpretation	20	Cautious overall interpretation	Discussion; Conclusions
Generalisability	21	External validity	Discussion, Implications (2024 rules); Limitations
Funding	22	Funding and role of funders	Funding

References

1. von Elm E, Altman DG, Egger M, et al. The Strengthening the Reporting of Observational Studies in Epidemiology (STROBE) Statement: Guidelines for Reporting Observational Studies. *PLoS Medicine*. 2007;4(10):e296. doi:10.1371/journal.pmed.0040296

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